

My definitions of:



Game **mechanics**



Game **systems**

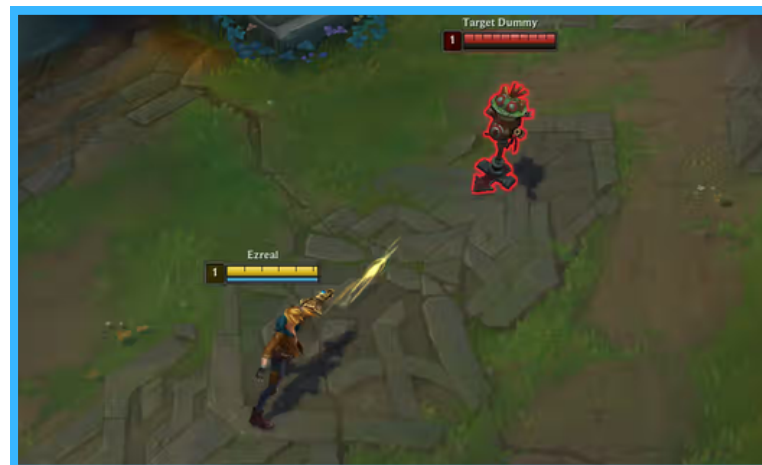


Game **loops**

Game mechanics

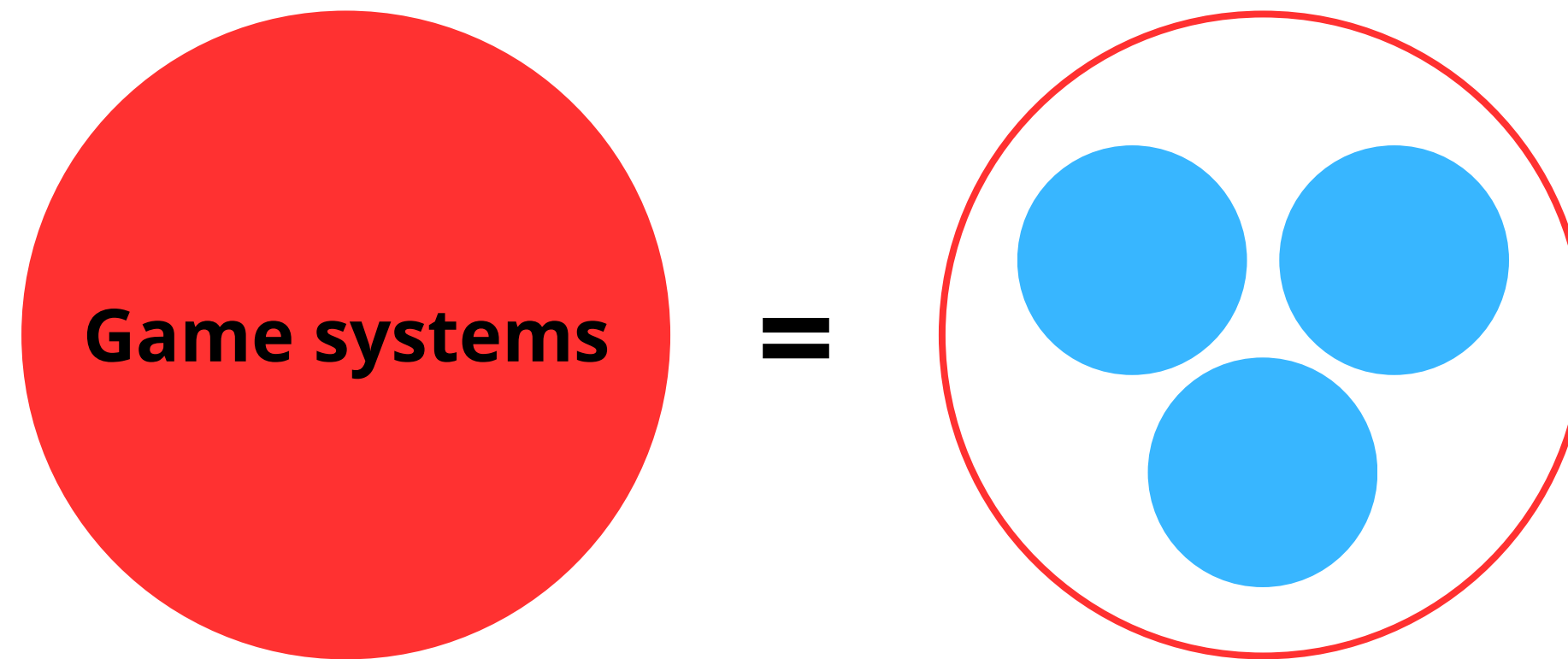
Game mechanics are the rules that define or guide what players can do.

The player can rightclick to auto attack



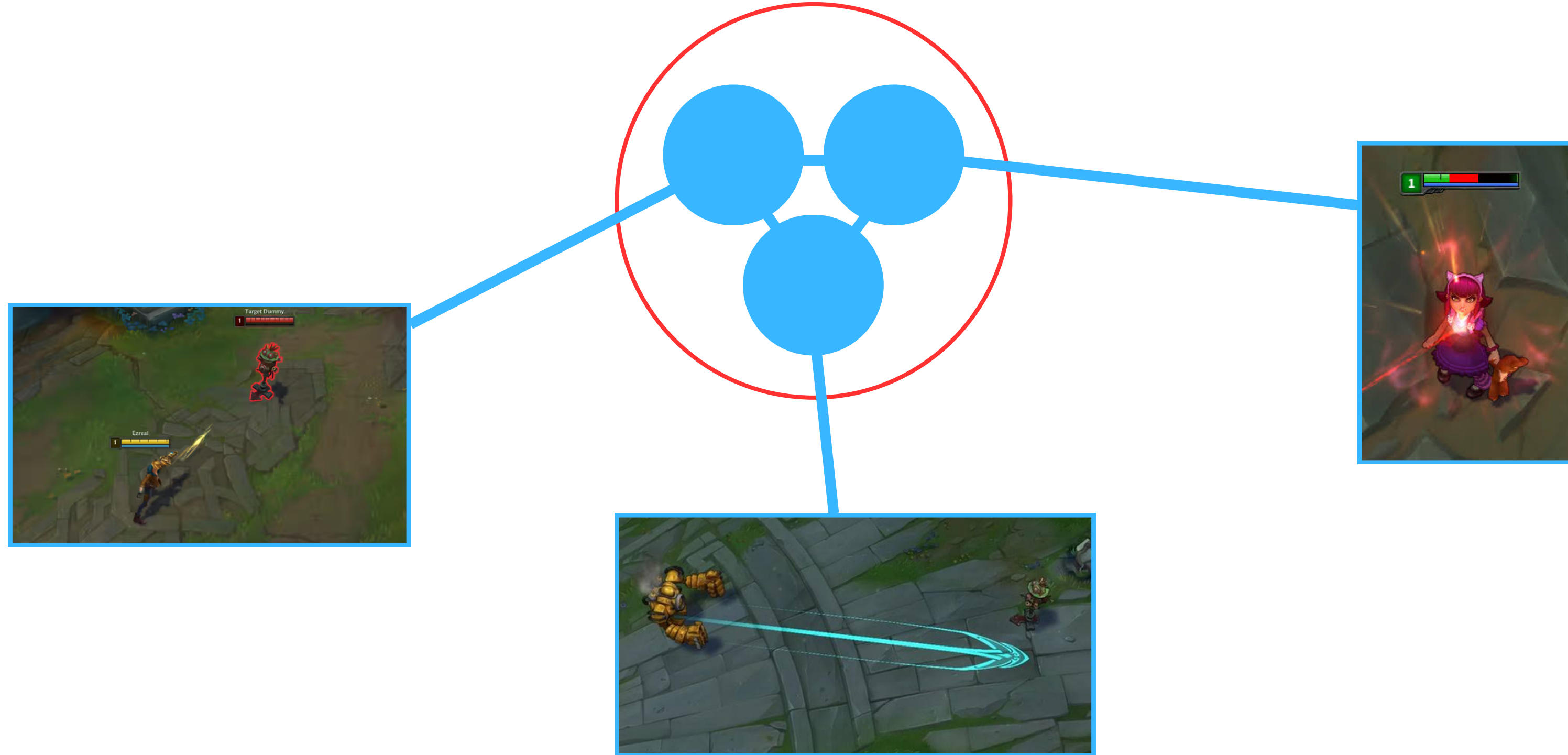
The player can press Q to cast a spell





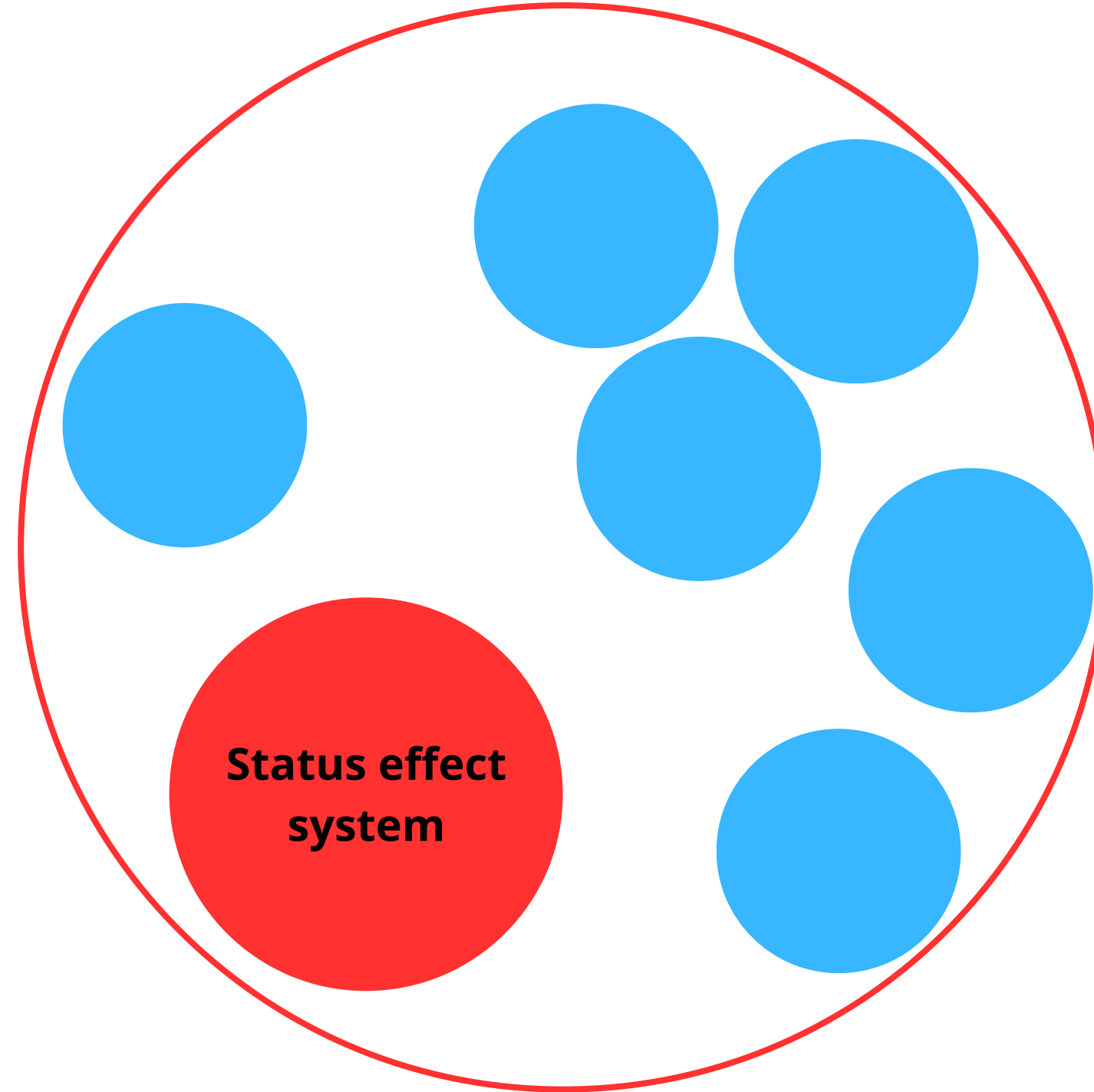
Game systems are a bunch of connected game mechanics in a frenchcoat

Combat system



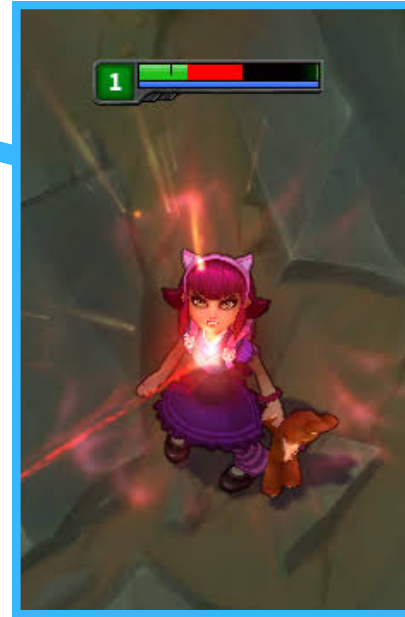
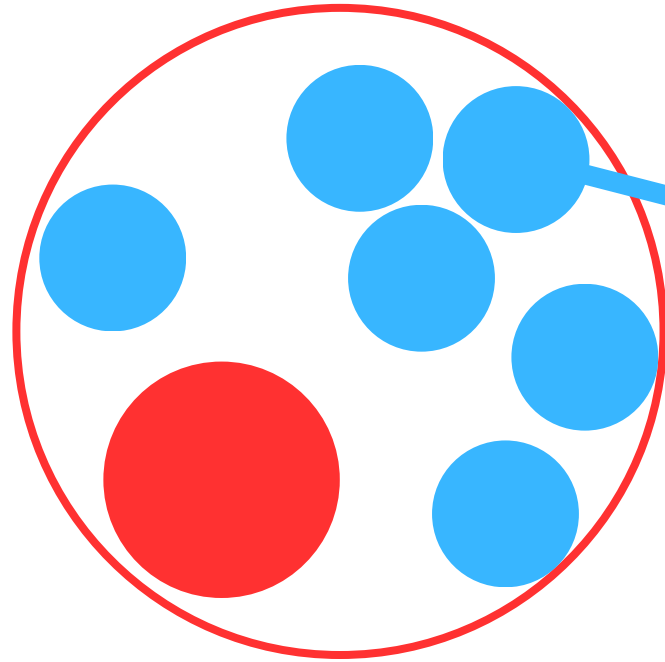
They work together toward a specific function (this case, combat)

Combat system

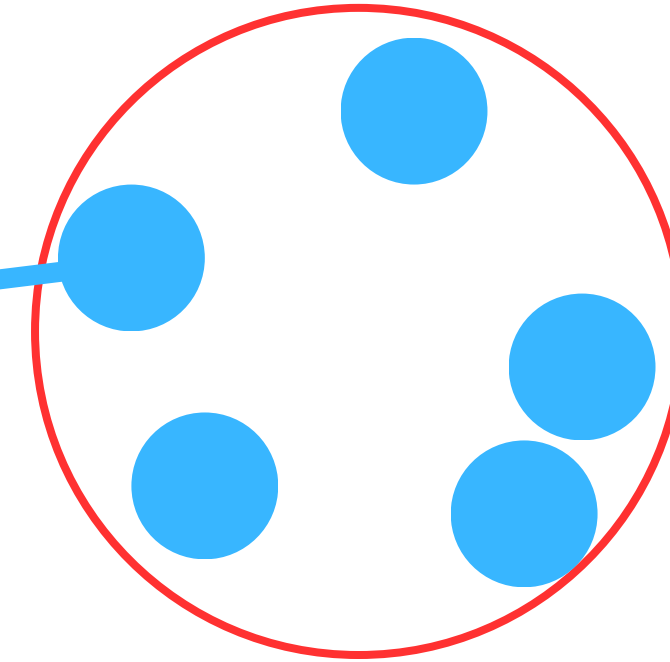


A game system can also be composed of other game system(s).

Combat system



Item system



Two game systems can share a game mechanic

Game loops

(designer)

Not to be confused with

Game loops

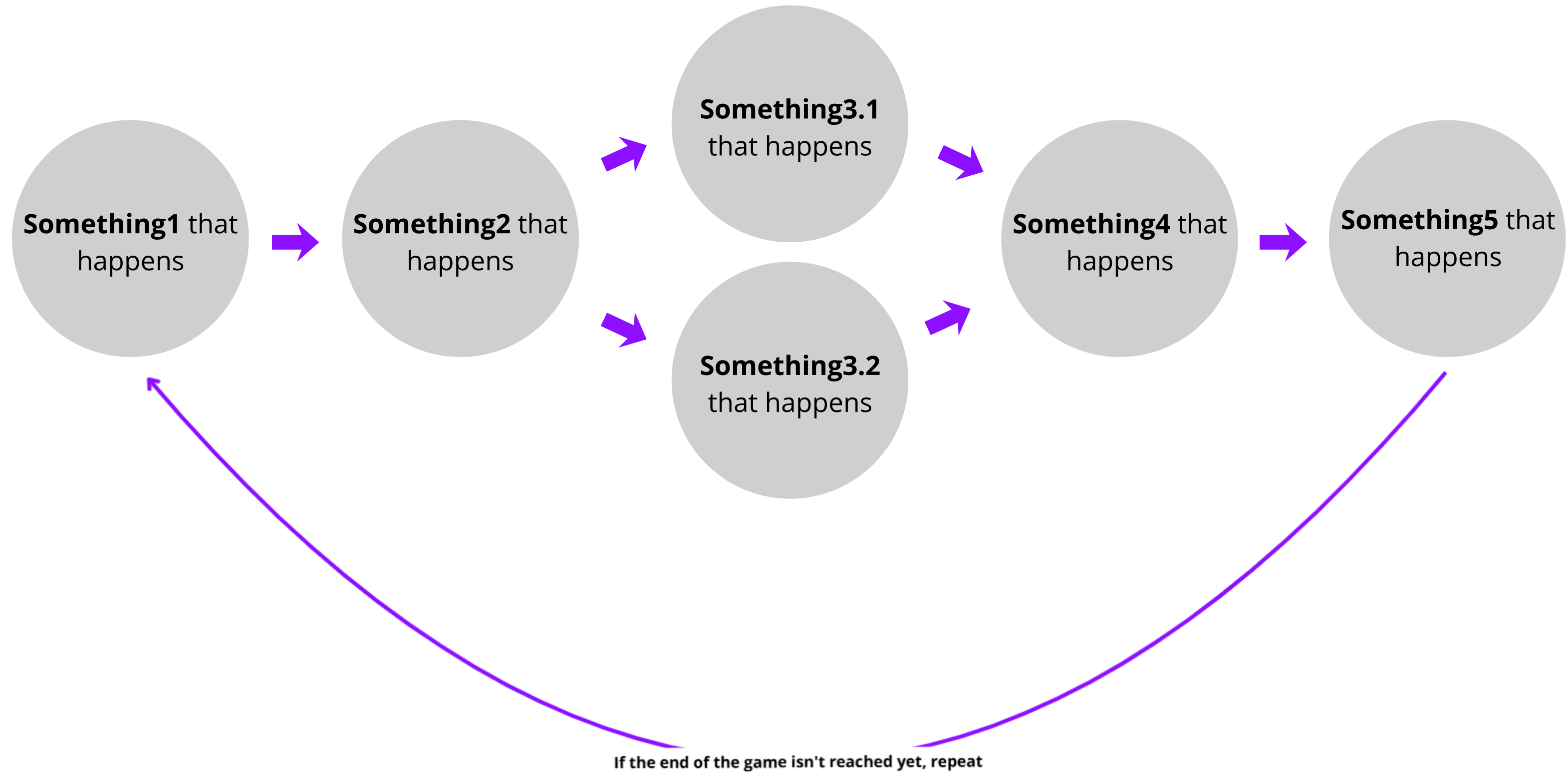
(developer)

```
1.process player input →  
2.update game stuff →  
3.render game stuff →
```

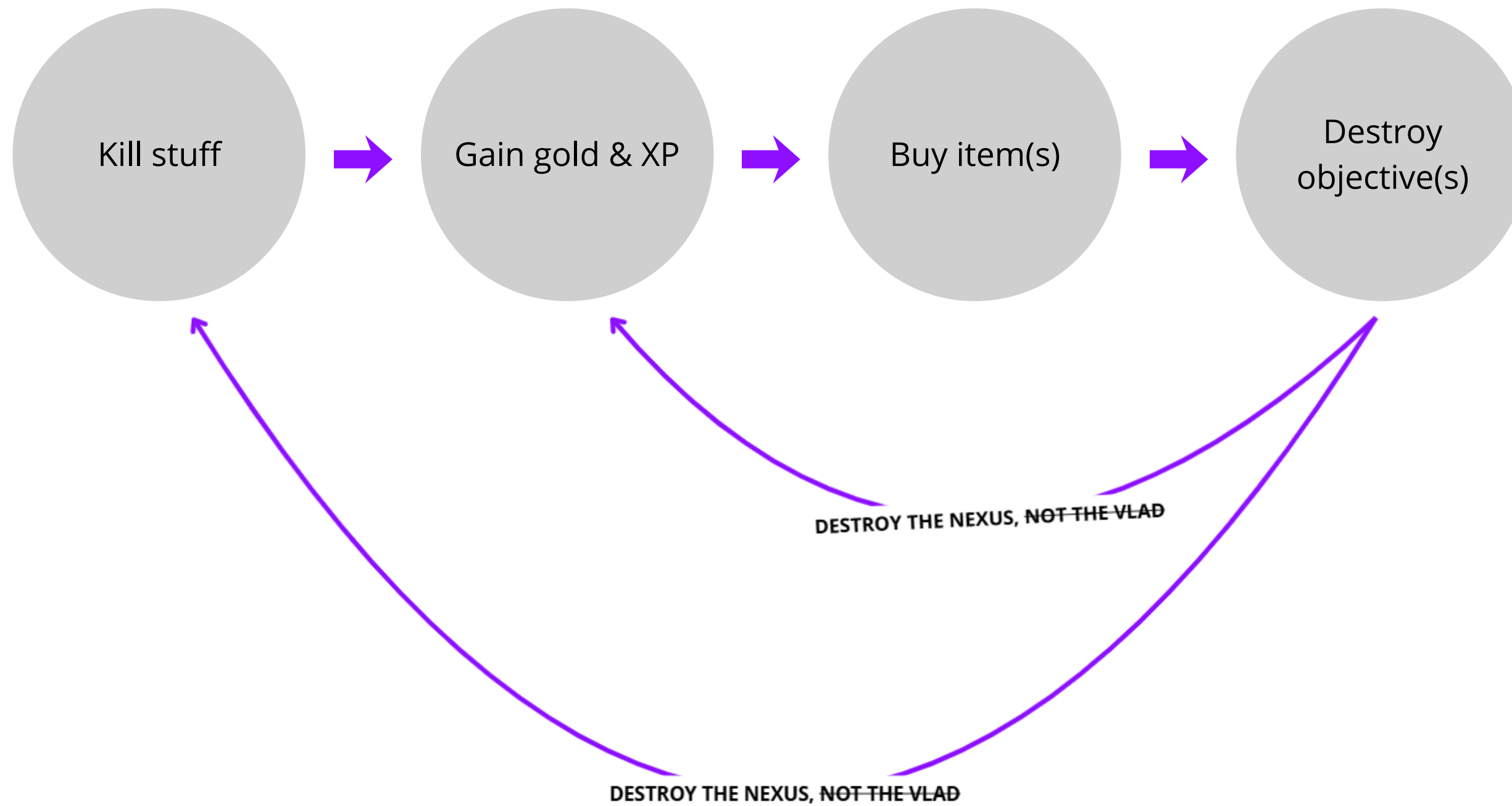
(The definition of game loops differ depending on if you ask a game designer or a game developer)

Game loop

A game loop has a bunch of repeating steps:

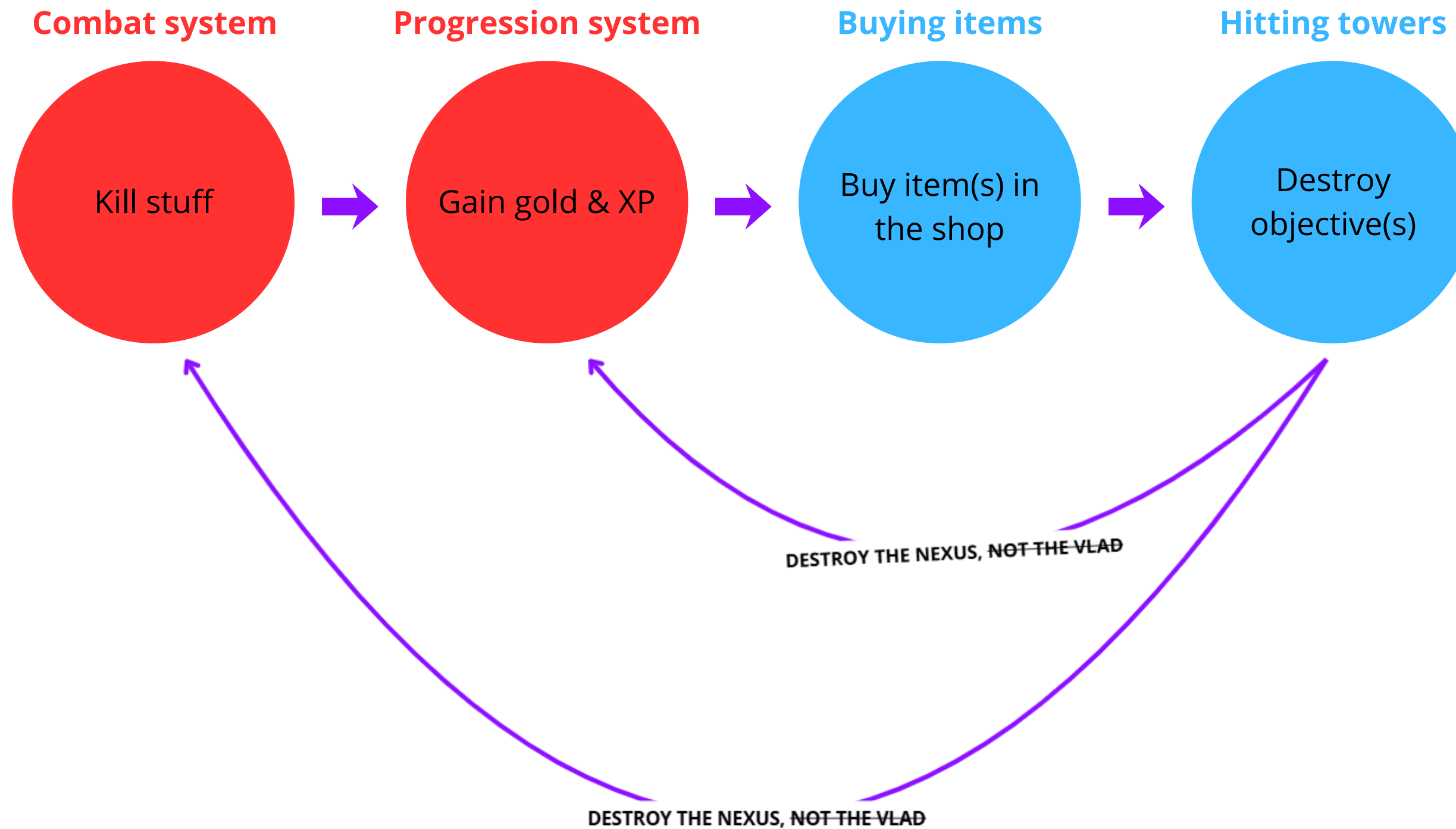


One of 's Game loops:

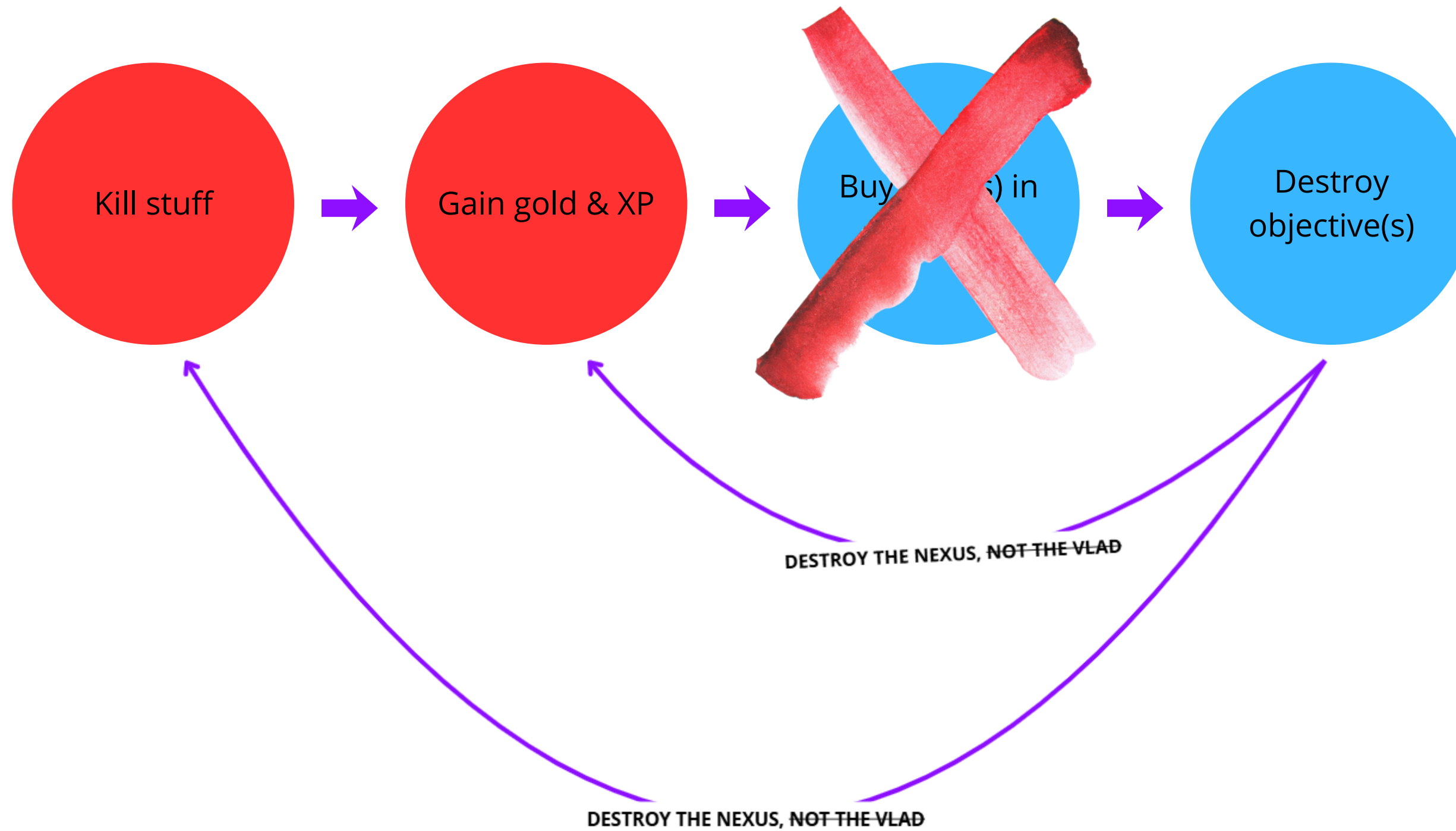


Pay attention, and you'll notice...

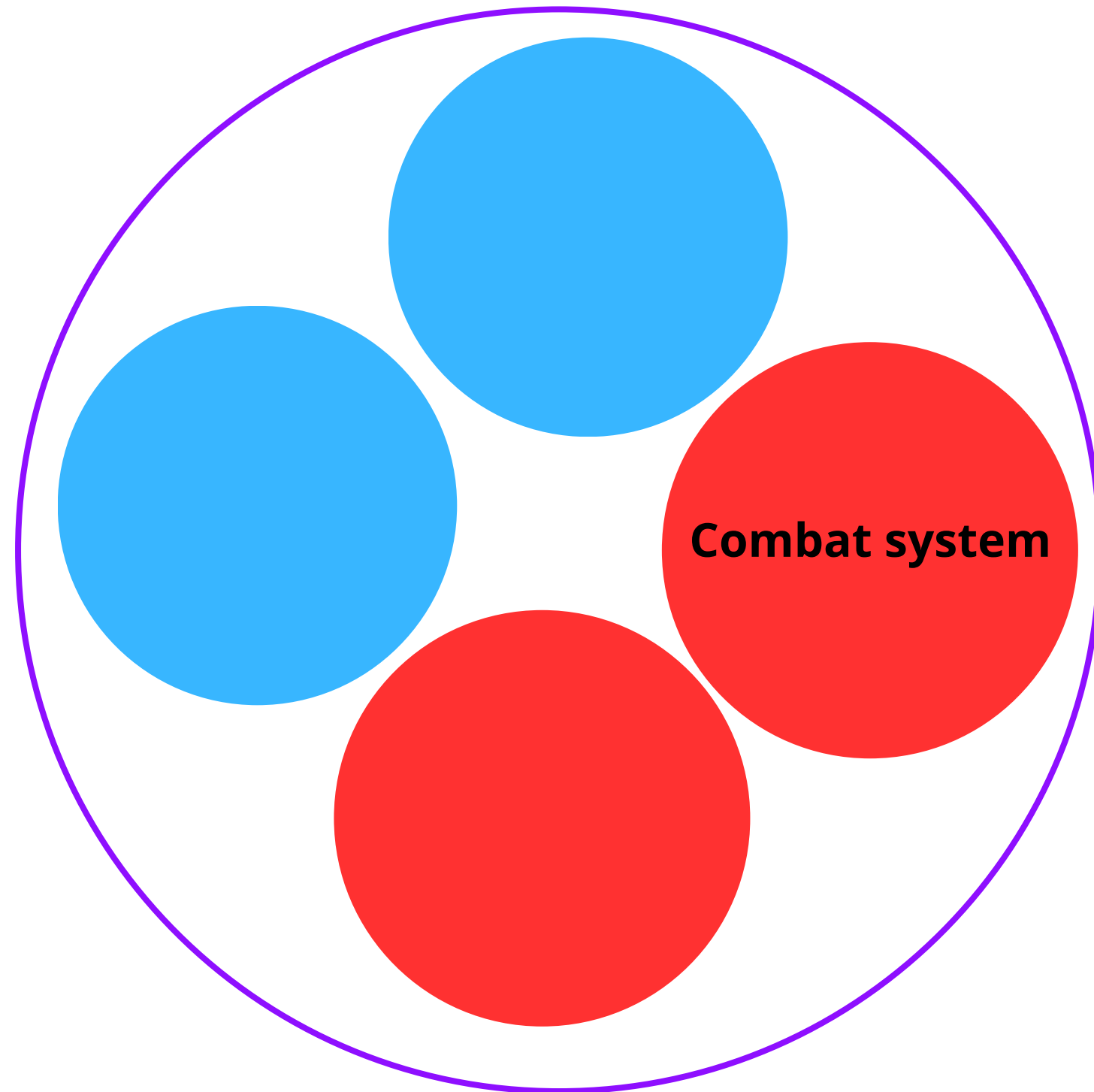
These steps are all either game mechanics or game systems!



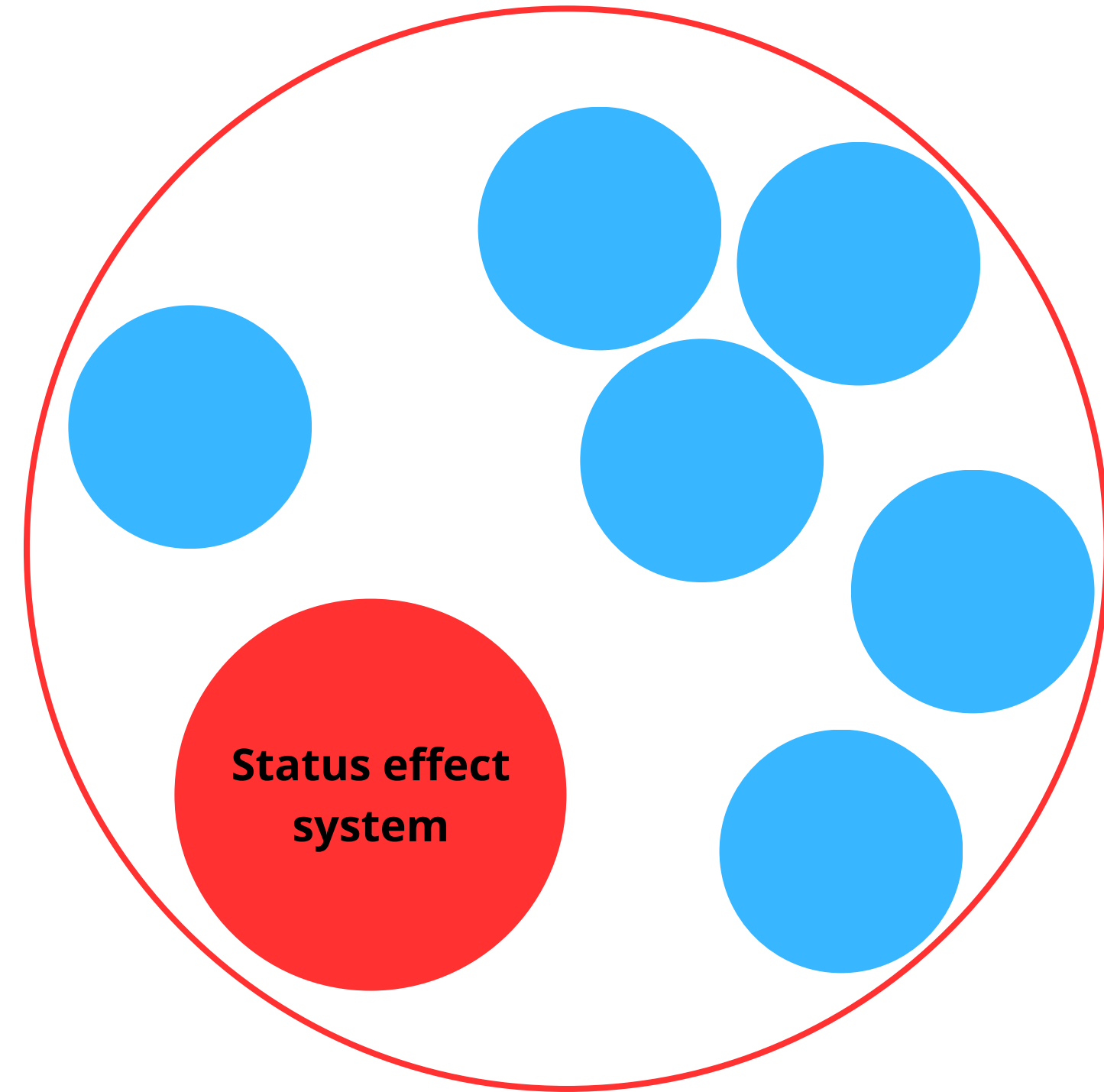
It's possible for players to be quirky and skip a step, but then that wouldn't be the **INTENDED** game loop



Game **Loops**



Combat system



It's like atoms and molecules